

SolarMax

Install Git & Get the Code in VS Code — macOS

Install Homebrew → install Git → clone the project, all from VS Code.

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1. What this does

This installs **Git** on your Mac using **Homebrew** (a package installer), adds a Git extension to **VS Code** so it's easy to see, and clones the SolarMax project straight from inside VS Code. After this you get the latest code with one click any time — no re-downloading ZIPs.

Note

You already have VS Code + PlatformIO from the Flashing guide. We'll do everything here **inside VS Code**, including the Terminal commands.

2. What you need

- A Mac with internet, and VS Code installed.
- Your Mac **login password** (the installers ask for it).

3. Step 1 — Install Homebrew (in VS Code's terminal)

1. Open VS Code. In the top menu: **Terminal** → **New Terminal** (a command panel opens at the bottom).

2. Go to brew.sh and copy its install command — or just paste this one (it’s the same) and press **Return**:

```
/bin/bash -c "$(curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Homebrew/install/HEAD/install.sh)"
```

3. Type your **Mac password** when asked (the characters stay hidden — that’s normal) and press **Return**. Let it run; it takes a few minutes.

Note

Homebrew may first install Apple’s “Command Line Tools” automatically — that’s expected, just let it finish.

Important

When it’s done, Homebrew prints a “**Next steps**” section with **two lines** to run (they add Homebrew to your PATH). **Copy those two lines from your terminal and run them.** On Apple-silicon Macs they look like this:

```
echo 'eval "$(/opt/homebrew/bin/brew shellenv)"' >> ~/.zprofile
eval "$(/opt/homebrew/bin/brew shellenv)"
```

Confirm Homebrew works:

```
brew --version
```

A version number (e.g. Homebrew 4.x.x) means it’s ready.

4. Step 2 — Install Git with Homebrew

In the same terminal:

```
brew install git
```

Then confirm:

```
git --version
```

Any version number (e.g. `git version 2.45.0`) means Git is installed.

Tip

Now **quit and reopen VS Code** once. This lets it detect the newly installed Git and turn on its Source Control features.

5. Step 3 — Add the GitLens extension in VS Code

VS Code already has built-in Git support; **GitLens** makes it more visual (history, who changed what, a commit graph) — nice for beginners.

1. Click the **Extensions** icon in the left bar (four squares).

2. Search for **GitLens**.
3. Click **Install** on “GitLens — Git supercharged”.

Note

This is optional but recommended. Even without it, the **Source Control** icon in the left bar (the branch symbol) already lets you clone, pull, and commit.

6. Step 4 — Clone SolarMax from inside VS Code

No terminal needed for this — use VS Code’s command palette:

1. Press **Cmd + Shift + P** to open the Command Palette.
2. Type **Git: Clone** and select it.
3. Paste the project’s address and press **Return**:

```
https://github.com/zhsquared/SolarMax.git
```

4. Choose a folder to put it in (your **Documents** folder is a good choice) and click **Select as Repository Destination**.
5. When VS Code asks “**Would you like to open the cloned repository?**”, click **Open**.

You now have the newest SolarMax code open in VS Code.

Important

If you had an older **ZIP** copy of the project, use this cloned folder from now on, and re-apply your own **config.h** settings here — your Wi-Fi (lines 9–10) and location (lines 4–5).

7. Step 5 — Getting updates later (in VS Code)

When there’s new code, pull it without re-downloading anything:

1. Click the **Source Control** icon in the left bar (branch symbol).
2. Click the “...” menu at the top of that panel → **Pull**.

(Or click the little **sync** arrows next to the branch name at the bottom-left of the window.) That’s it — you’re on the newest version.

8. Troubleshooting

- **brew: command not found:** the PATH step didn’t run. Re-run the two “Next steps” lines Homebrew printed (Step 1), then **reopen the terminal** and try **brew --version** again.
- **git: command not found after installing:** quit and reopen VS Code (and the terminal) so it picks up the new install.
- **Password prompt shows nothing as you type:** that’s normal for terminal passwords — type it and press **Return**.

- **Git: Clone isn't in the Command Palette:** Git isn't detected yet — finish Step 2, then quit and reopen VS Code.
- **Clone fails partway:** usually a network hiccup — run **Git: Clone** again with the same address.